

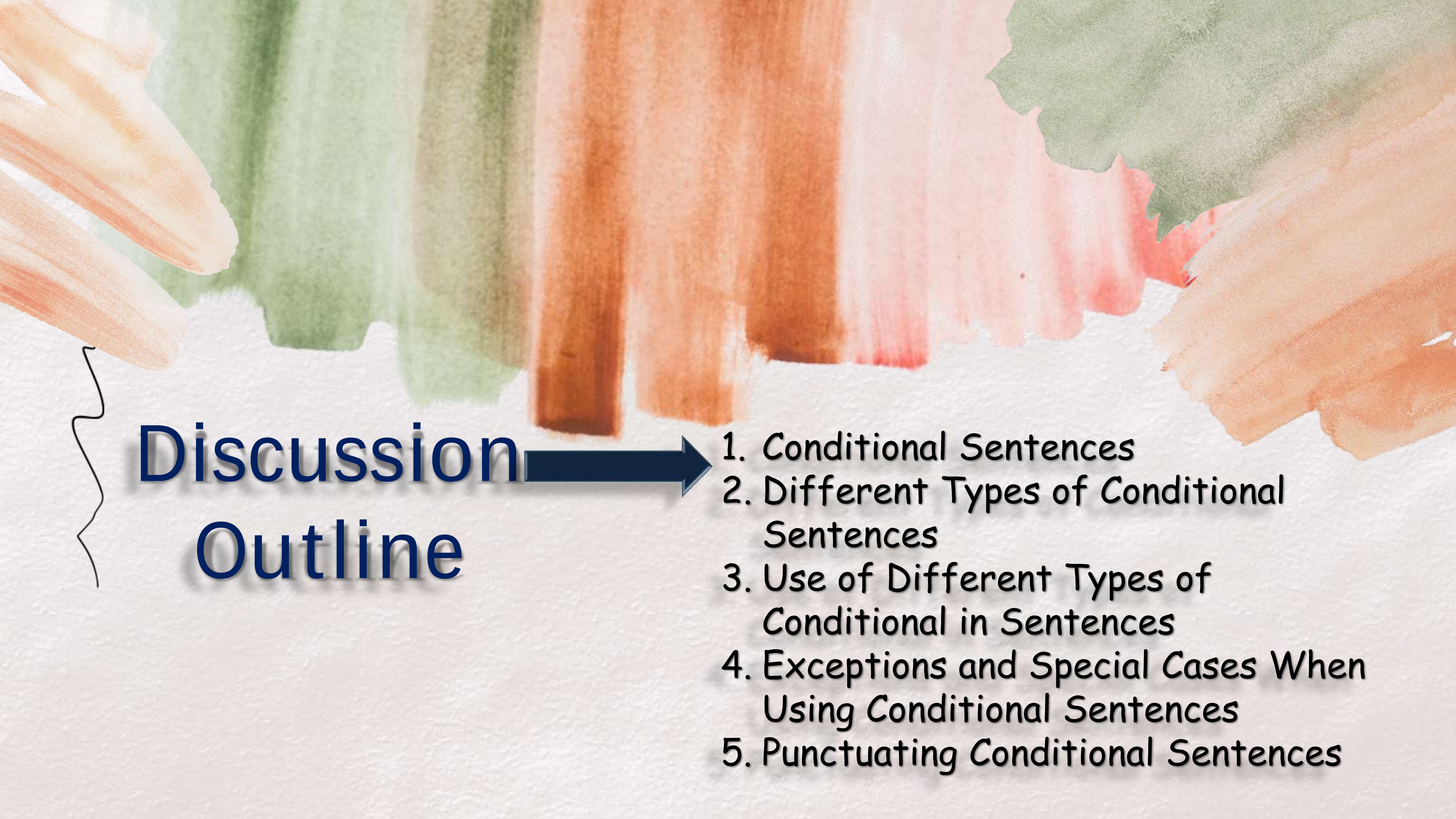
CONDITIONALS

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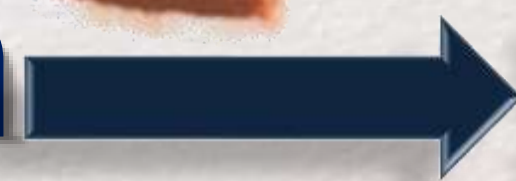
ENG 101 ✨ October 30, 2023

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Discussion Outline



1. Conditional Sentences
2. Different Types of Conditional Sentences
3. Use of Different Types of Conditional in Sentences
4. Exceptions and Special Cases When Using Conditional Sentences
5. Punctuating Conditional Sentences



Conditional Sentences

What is conditional sentences?

- ❑ Conditional sentences are statements discussing known factors or hypothetical situations and their consequences.
- ❑ Complete conditional sentences contain a conditional clause (often referred to as the if-clause) and the consequence.
- ❑ The "if" clause states the condition (If you study hard) and the main clause states the result (you will pass your exams).
- ❑ The order of the clauses does not change the meaning.
Ex: If you study hard, you will pass your exams.
You will pass your exams if you study hard.



Different Types of Conditional Sentences

❑ What are the different types of conditional sentences?

- There are four different types of conditional sentences in English. They are -
 - i. **Zero Conditional Sentences**
 - ii. **First Conditional Sentences**
 - iii. **Second Conditional Sentences**
 - iv. **Third Conditional Sentences**
- Each expresses a different degree of probability that a situation will occur or would have occurred under certain circumstances.
- It's important to use the correct structure for each of these different conditional sentences because they express varying meanings.
- Pay attention to verb tense when using different conditional modes.



Use of Different Types of Conditional Sentences

How to Use Zero Conditional Sentences?

⌘ Zero conditional sentences express general truths—situations in which one thing always causes another.

⌘ When you use a zero conditional, you're talking about a general truth rather than a specific instance of something.

Ex: If you **don't brush** your teeth, you **get** cavities.
When people **smoke** cigarettes, their health **suffers**.

⌘ When using the zero conditional, the correct tense to use in both clauses is the present indefinite tense. A common mistake is to use the simple future tense.

Ex: *When people smoke cigarettes, their health will suffer.*

⌘ Notice that the words “if” and “when” can be used interchangeably in these zero conditional sentences. This is because the outcome will always be the same, so it doesn't matter “if” or “when” it happens.

How to Use First Conditional Sentences?

- First conditional sentences are used to express situations in which the outcome is likely (but not guaranteed) to happen in the future.

Ex: If you rest, you will feel better.

If you set your mind to a goal, you will eventually achieve it.

- Use the present indefinite tense in the if-clause and the future indefinite tense in the main clause—that is the clause that expresses the likely outcome. This is how we indicate that under a certain condition (as expressed in the if-clause), a specific result will likely happen in the future.

- **REMEMBER:**

- ☒ Use the present indefinite tense in the if-clause.

Incorrect: *If you will rest, you will feel better.*

Correct: *If you rest, you will feel better.*

- ☒ Use the zero conditional (i.e., present indefinite + present indefinite) only when a certain result is guaranteed. If the result is likely, use the first conditional (i.e., present indefinite + future indefinite).

Ex: *If you study hard, you will pass your exams.*

How to Use Second Conditional Sentences?

- ❑ Second conditional sentences are useful for expressing outcomes that are completely unrealistic or never happened.

Ex: *If I **inherited** a billion dollars, I **would travel** to the moon.*

*If I **owned** a zoo, I **might let** people interact with the animals more.*

- ❑ The correct way to structure second conditional sentences is to use the **past indefinite tense** in the **if-clause** and an **auxiliary modal verb** (e.g., *could, should, would, might*) in the **main clause** (*the one that expresses the unrealistic or unlikely outcome*).

❑ REMEMBER:

- When applying the second conditional, use the **past indefinite tense** in the **if-clause**.

Incorrect: *If I **inherit** a billion dollars, I **would travel** to the moon.*

Correct: *If I **inherited** a billion dollars, I **would travel** to the moon.*

- Use a **modal auxiliary verb** in the **main clause** when using the second conditional mood to express *the unlikelihood* that the result will actually happen.

How to Use Third Conditional Sentences?

- Third conditional sentences are used to explain that present circumstances would be different if something different had happened in the past.

Ex: If you *had told* me you needed a ride, I *would have left* earlier.

If I *had cleaned* the house, I *could have gone* to the movies.

These sentences express a condition that was likely enough, but did not actually happen in the past. The speaker in the first sentence was capable of leaving early, but did not. Along these same lines, the speaker in the second sentence was capable of cleaning the house, but did not.

- When using the third conditional, we use the past perfect (i.e., *had* + *past participle*) in the *if*-clause. The modal auxiliary (*would, could, should, etc.*) + have + past participle in the *main clause* expresses the theoretical situation that could have happened.
- With third conditional sentences, do not use a modal auxiliary verb in the *if*-clause. The third conditional mood expresses a situation that could have only happened in the past if a certain condition had been met. That's why we use the modal auxiliary verb + *have* + the *past participle*.



Exceptions and Special Cases When Using Conditional Sentences

1. Use of the future indefinite in the "if-clause":

- ✓ Generally, the future indefinite should be used only in the main clause.
- ✓ One exception – when the action in the "if-clause" will take place after the action in the main clause. For example,
If aspirin **will ease** my headache, I **will take** a couple tonight.
 - The action in the "if-clause" is the aspirin easing the headache, which will take place only after the speaker takes them later that night.

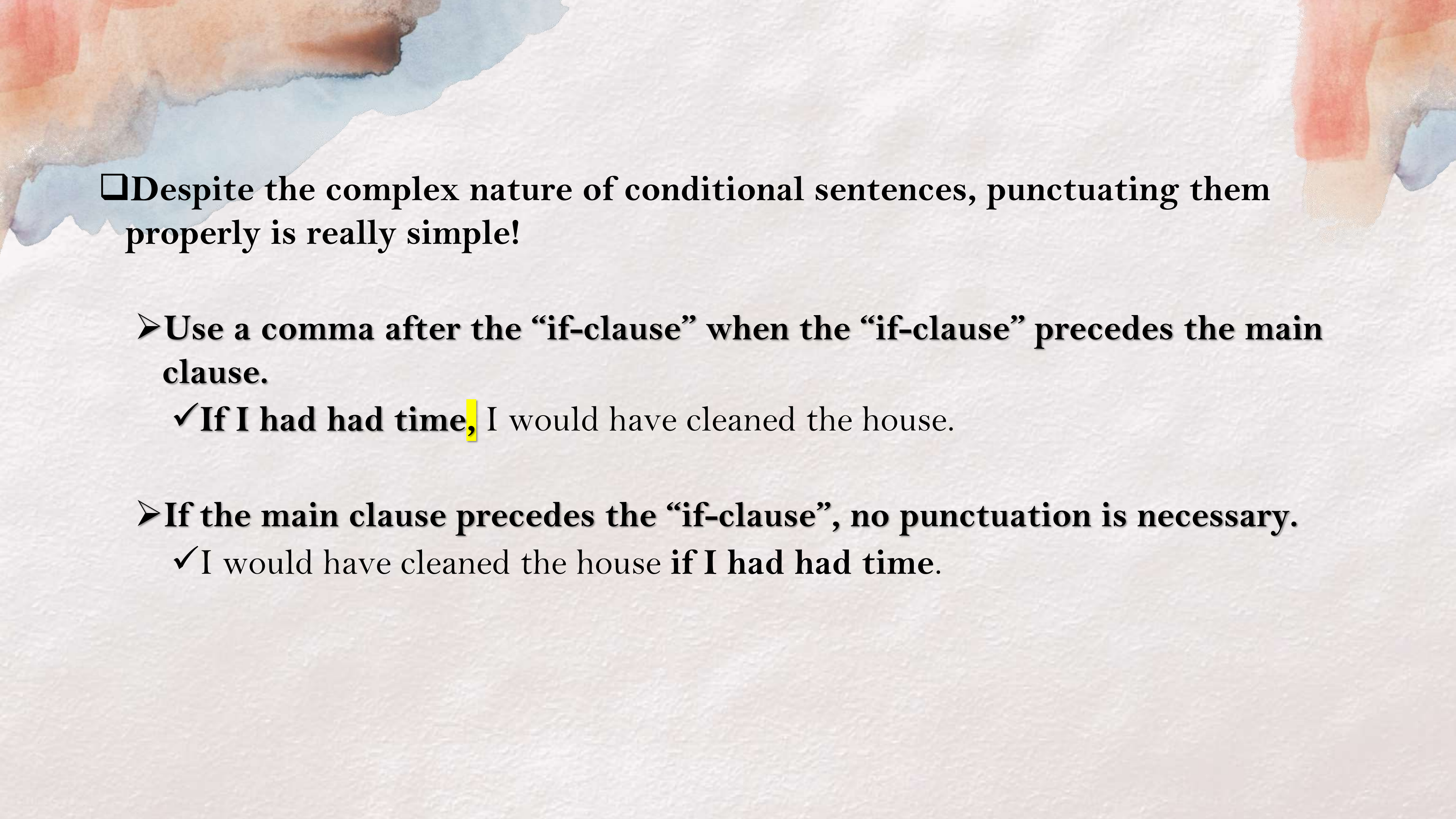
2. "Were to" in the "if-clause":

- ✓ "were to" used when the likely or unlikely result is particularly awful or unthinkable.
- ✓ In this case, "were to" is used to place emphasis on this potential outcome.
- ✓ Example: If I **were to be sick**, I **would miss** another day of work.
If she **were to be** late again, she **would have** to have a conference with the manager.
If the rent **were to have been** a penny more, they **would not have been** able to pay it.

□ NB: The emphatic "were to" can be used to describe hypothetical scenarios in the present, future, or past.



Punctuating Conditional Sentences



❑ Despite the complex nature of conditional sentences, punctuating them properly is really simple!

➤ Use a comma after the “if-clause” when the “if-clause” precedes the main clause.

✓ If I had had time, I would have cleaned the house.

➤ If the main clause precedes the “if-clause”, no punctuation is necessary.

✓ I would have cleaned the house if I had had time.



Thank You

ANY
Questions?